

What builds trust?

The quality of the products themselves should ideally be the most important parameter by which consumers build their trust in a particular brand. In reality, however, there are a myriad number of factors which go into this overall T-factor. For instance, consumer perception - driven to a great extent by aggressive marketing strategies employed by companies - contributes a lot. At the outset at least, a weak product will gain some amount of traction in the market thanks to this sort of a push, until word spreads. As a technology navigator our role is to prevent even these initial disappointments by way of our news, reviews, buying guides and analysis, by which we aim to empower the consumer. We cut through the jargon and distill some unbiased, objective and rational advice your way. The Icons of Trust research report is one such effort that collates the collective intelligence of people just like you and in turn empowering you to make

the right purchases going forward. For tech brands it's an opportunity to put their ears to the ground and gauge the rumblings of their consumers.

How is trust calculated?

All respondents are asked to complete a rather long and comprehensive questionnaire, which aims at arriving at scores for six parameters: Awareness, Availability, Credibility, Loyalty, Quality and Satisfaction. These six factors are what determine how much the respondents "trust" a brand.

Awareness: Not all of you own a product from all the categories we cover, but buying decisions depend a lot on your awareness and the market's awareness of a brand. You're not likely to buy or recommend something you've never heard of before, are you? To quantify awareness, we asked the respondents open ended questions to judge unaided brand recall and later revealed a list to measure aided recall. Awareness is like a much needed popularity

contest and depends a lot on how well a brand markets itself within our shores.

Awareness had a weight of 10 in the overall score.

Availability: How easily a brand or more importantly a desired model of a brand is available is an important factor in building trust towards that brand. Products that forever remain on a consumer's wishlist for lack of availability are not really worth the hype

Credibility: Questions that assessed credibility tried to bring out how much respondents trusted a brand. Questions were asked to gauge what respondents felt about the improvements in a brand's products, technological advancement, ease of use etc. This parameter was a substantial contributor to the overall trust index, weighing in at 15 per cent.

Satisfaction: As owners of a brand's products, how satisfied you are with a product is one of the key factors that influence how much you trust the brand. Questions judged

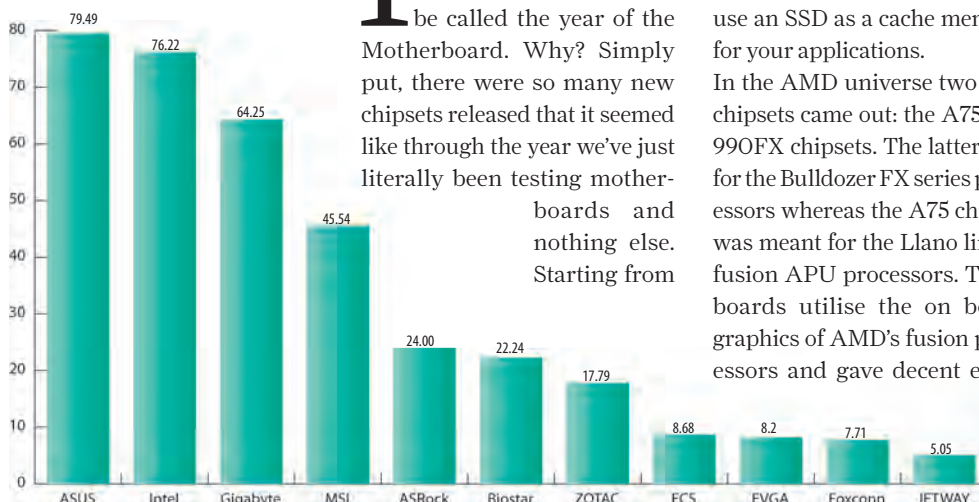
after sales service; whether repairs and service was hassle-free, how easy was it to get after-sales support etc. Weighing in at 15 percent this was one of the more important factors contributing to the overall trust index.

Loyalty: Although at Digit we strive to give fanboyism a wide berth, you have to give credit to brands for being able to incite passion in their buyers. To ascertain loyalty we asked respondents whether, based on their experiences, they would buy a product in a different category from the same brand. We also gauged how eager the respondents were to recommend products from a brand to friends and relatives, and whether the respondents generally spoke positively or negatively about the brand.

Quality: Questions around reliability, design, innovation and features were grouped under this category. Since quality is of paramount importance, this category was given a weight of 20 in the overall trust index.



Motherboards



If the last year had to be named after one product category, it would have to be called the year of the Motherboard. Why? Simply put, there were so many new chipsets released that it seemed like through the year we've just literally been testing motherboards and nothing else. Starting from

the H67 and P67 Sandybridge series boards. To have the best features of these boards Intel released Z68. The new chipset had features such as Smart Response which allows you to use an SSD as a cache memory for your applications.

In the AMD universe two new chipsets came out: the A75 and 990FX chipsets. The latter was for the Bulldozer FX series processors whereas the A75 chipset was meant for the Llano line of fusion APU processors. These boards utilise the on board graphics of AMD's fusion processors and gave decent entry



ASUS
Reaching out to the tech power user community worked for ASUS making it the most trusted brand in motherboards

level gaming performance. For all these chipsets, vendors such as ASRock, ASUS, Gigabyte, Biostar and many more came out with offerings with their own little twists and tweaks. UEFI Bios was one of the main differentiators between offerings. Also form factors were a factor by which brands enticed consumers. Some brands such